

I'm an African international student from Tunisia on a student visa, currently seeking asylum in the United States. To be able to remain enrolled, Armand Link, a fellow undergraduate Computer Science major in GS, generously co-signed a private educational loan for me so that I could keep my student visa and avoid deportation. He recognized the suffering I have experienced, as a fellow gay man, the persecution I endured in Tunisia where homosexuality is illegal. He co-signed my loan so that I could continue my education and avoid deportation. There is a Columbia article in which he shares his experience:

<https://www.gs.columbia.edu/news/their-own-words-river-divided-my-childhood-and-shaped-my-future> , to afford Columbia thus far, I have also relied on fundraising. The 116th

Initiative, an organization dedicated to helping Columbia students navigate financial hardship, organized a campaign on my behalf. Through the generosity of many members of the Columbia community, we raised approximately \$17,000. This was extremely challenging, and it required the support of many Columbia students to help me keep my visa and avoid deportation. The campaign was featured on their official Instagram: https://www.instagram.com/p/C_Q37ESJ7r0/?hl=en&img_index=1 and https://www.instagram.com/p/C_ITepJpi7X/?hl=en&img_index=1 \$17,000 was spent on Columbia summer housing and Fall 2025 tuition. I currently have an outstanding balance.

I'm writing to kindly request a waiver of the \$1,000 lease termination fee for my Columbia Residential housing, as I'm moving out solely to reduce my living expenses so I can afford my tuition and remain enrolled. I'm trying every possible avenue to cover my educational costs, and moving out of campus housing is one of the few concrete steps I can take to reduce expenses. Imposing a \$1,000 lease-break fee would effectively cancel out the savings from this difficult decision and make it harder for me to resolve my outstanding balance, stay enrolled to avoid deportation, and complete my degree in 2026. I therefore kindly and urgently ask that Columbia Residential consider waiving this fee in light of my exceptional financial and immigration circumstances.